

MarkMate

An AI-powered Grading Assistant

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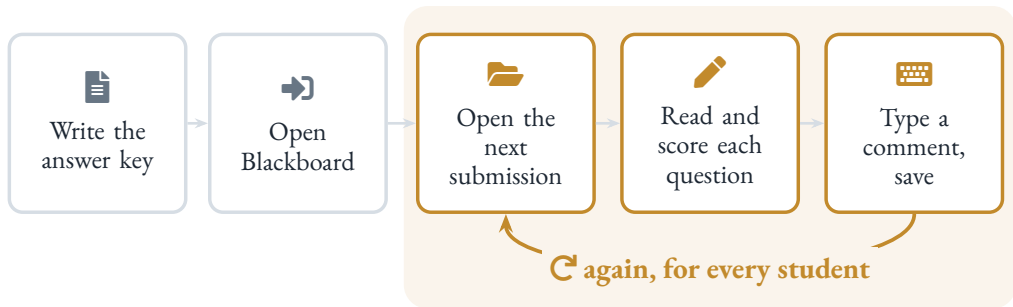
Acknowledgments

- MarkMate received a Teaching award in the first GW Business AI in Action Awards, in May 2026.
- We thank the GW Business Dean's Office for organizing these awards.

WHY

Grading, by hand

One assignment, in Blackboard



WHY

Grading well is hard!



**Grading every student
the same way**

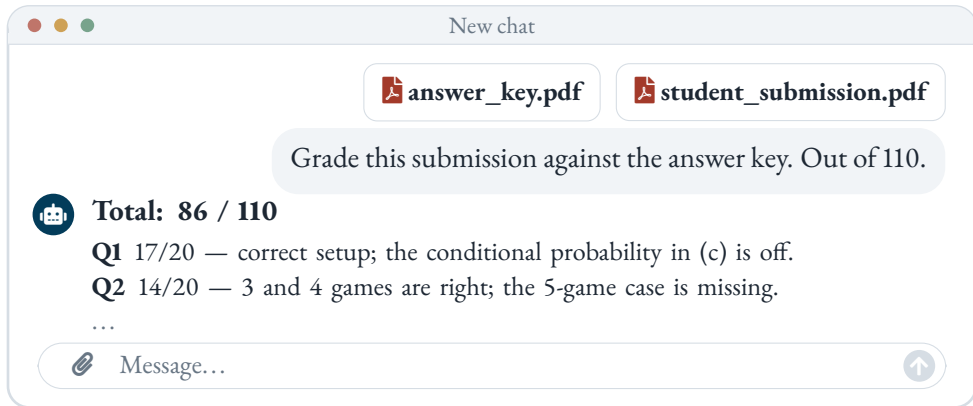


**Good feedback takes
a lot of energy**

...

WHY

So why not let AI grade?



For one submission, it already works.

WHY

But...



Still one at a time

Download, upload, copy the grade back — for every student.

WHY

But...



Still one at a time

Download, upload, copy the grade back — for every student.



No guarantee of consistency

It may not grade every student the same way.

WHY

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No guarantee of consistency

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How do you check it?

To trust the grades, you'd have to regrade every paper.

Can we automate the whole workflow
and make the grading more reliable?

MARKMATE

Every step is one click

 The assignment



**Generate
the rubric**

One click. No more working out the answers by hand.
And every student is graded against the same standard.

MARKMATE

Every step is one click



The assignment



**Generate
the rubric**



**Pull
submissions**

One click. No more opening each submission in Blackboard.

Every step is one click

 The assignment

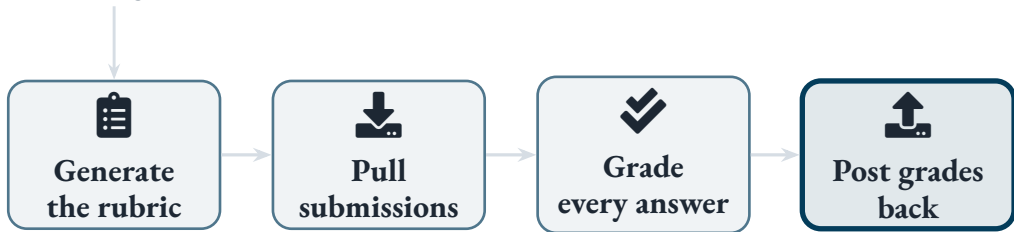


One click. No more reading, scoring and commenting one by one.

MARKMATE

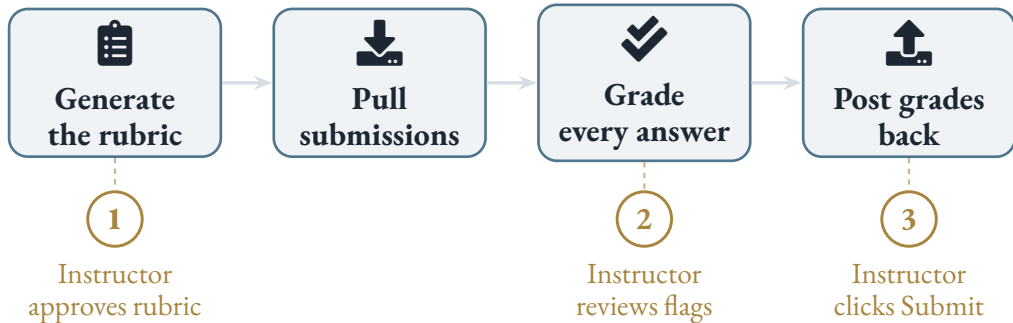
Every step is one click

 The assignment



One click. No more typing in every score and comment.

Three decisions stay with the instructor



What the site does, and why

 **LIVE DEMO**



Rubric

Drafts it from the assignment. You can edit it.

You set it



Fetch

Downloads the whole class from Blackboard.

No downloads



Grade

Grades everyone. Results show up one by one.

Read early



Review

Flags unclear cases and explains why.

See what to check



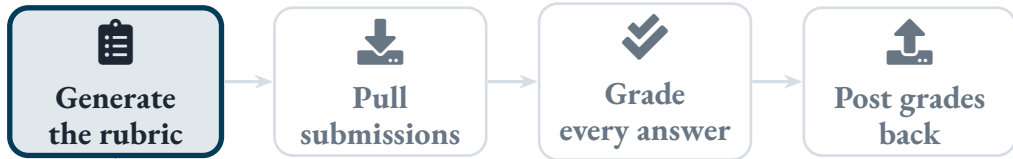
Push back

Fills in the grades and stops before Submit.

You submit

Step 1: the rubric

 LIVE DEMO

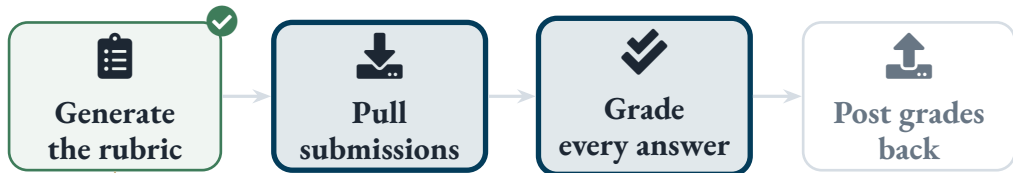


1

Instructor
approves rubric

Steps 2 & 3: pull and grade

 LIVE DEMO

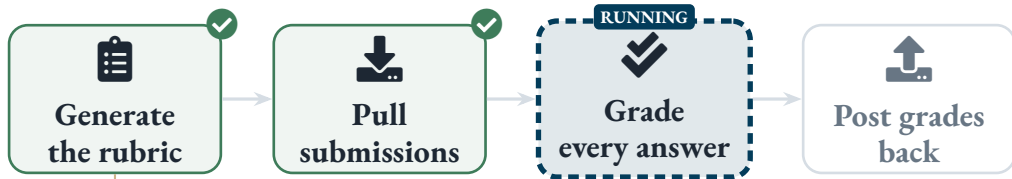


1

Instructor
approves rubric

UNDER THE HOOD

It's grading right now

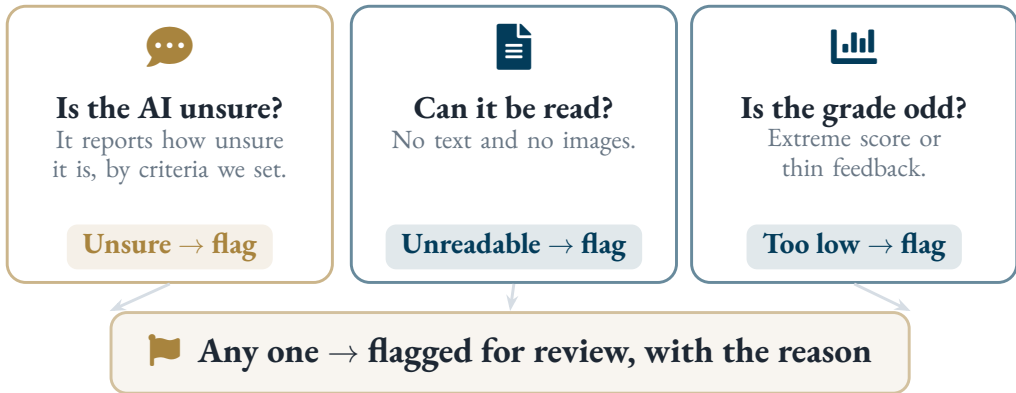


1

Instructor
approves rubric

UNDER THE HOOD

How do you check it?



UNDER THE HOOD

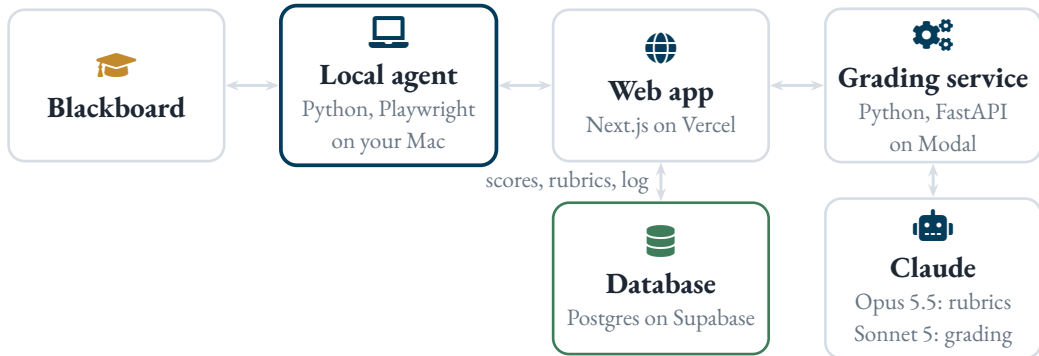
It shows where to look

✓ Student A	102 / 110		
🚩 Student B	88 / 110	AI unsure	Q4: the photo is too blurry to read
✓ Student C	95 / 110		
✓ Student D	71 / 110		
🚩 Student E	64 / 110	AI unsure	Q6: a method the rubric doesn't cover
✓ Student F	99 / 110		
✓ Student G	84 / 110		
🚩 Student H	0 / 110	Unreadable	The file couldn't be read
✓ Student I	93 / 110		

Only the flagged papers need a second look.

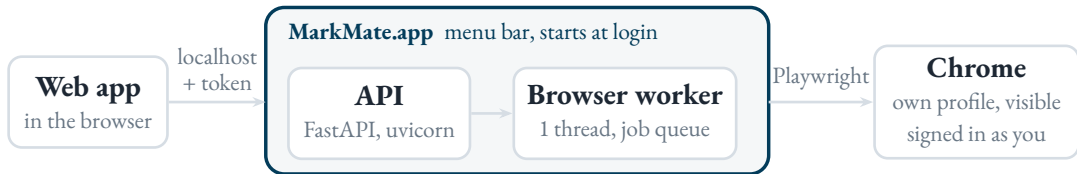
UNDER THE HOOD

How it's built



UNDER THE HOOD

The local agent



Your own login



Visible window



Never submits



Install once

Student data storage



Not stored

Submissions are read for grading and then deleted. MarkMate saves only scores, comments and the rubric.



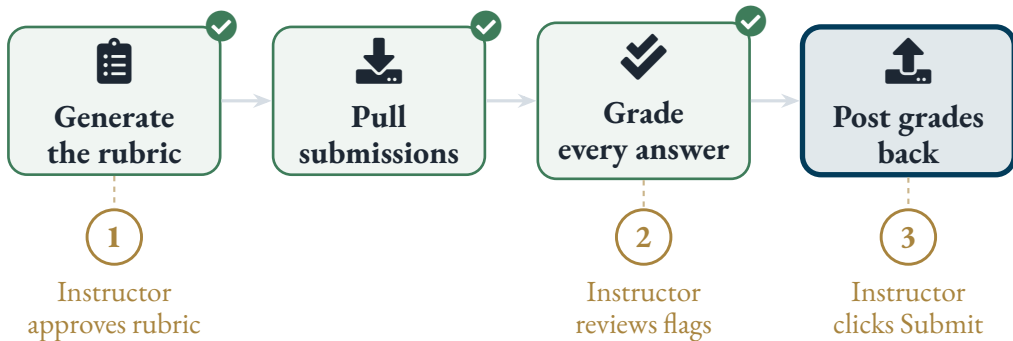
No files to manage

No folders of student files to download, sort, keep track of, or delete.

RESULTS

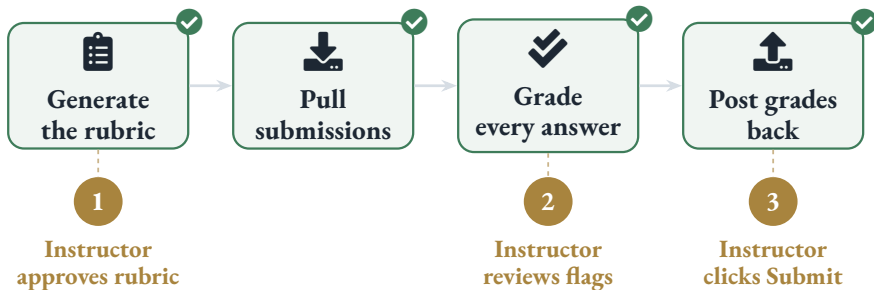
Let's see how it did

 LIVE DEMO



LOOKING AHEAD

Every step you just saw ran on its own



About \$1
to grade a typical stats class

About \$0.07
to draft a rubric

LOOKING AHEAD

Four months later

Spring 2026

```
def _find_and_click(self, page, goal, ...):  
    # Layer 1 -- CSS selectors  
    for sel in css_selectors or []:  
        try:  
            self._safe_click(page.locator(sel).first)  
            return sel  
        except Exception:  
            pass  
    # Layer 2 -- fuzzy text match  
    ...  
    # Layer 3 -- ask an LLM which link it is
```

September 2026 GPT-6 Astra



OpenAI launch video

LOOKING AHEAD

What will last

01 The rules

A model still does not know your course. It needs:

- the rubric
- when to flag
- who signs off
- what is enforced

02 The cost

Reliable computer use needs a frontier model, with a screenshot at every step.

- GPT-6 Astra: $5 \times$ the price per token
- MarkMate: direct API calls, far fewer tokens

LOOKING AHEAD

Where this goes

01 A skill for your AI

For instructors who already use Claude or Codex.

- Our workflow and rules, written as a skill
- Claude or Codex follows it to grade
- A step-by-step manual to go with it

02 A better MarkMate

For instructors who want it ready to use.

- Run the code in notebooks
- A Windows version of the agent
- Limits on usage and cost

Questions?

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